You Left An Impression

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/59588437.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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Alternate Universe - Fantasy, Tournaments, Au-ctober, Not Beta Read, Meet-Cute, except its getting the shit kicked out of you so hard you fall in love, Implied Sexual Content

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by ZullieFomx

Summary

Catra smirks stiffly, her eyes searching for hints of proposition. "And what kind of impression might that be?"

Adora's face burns a bright pink and she stammers, "N-No! Not, uh, not like that. You're..." she looks Catra up and down glacially, continuing, "incredibly fetching, but- why did I say that? Shit, um... I just wanted to learn more. From you. About how you fight." By the end of her explanation, she's evolved beyond pink to the utmost crimson and it's begun reaching her ears.

"Rrrrrright." Catra knowingly drawls the word, internally cackling at the embarrassment it draws out. "And you're here well after sunset to 'learn how to fight'."

Adora stares back with a gormless expression, offering a half-hearted "Yes?"

Just a really short lil meet cute thingy for AUctober

Notes

AU-ctober Day 7: Tournament
Yeah so this was supposed to go up yesterday but I'm an idiot. Not beta read and probably terrible but I'm sick of working on it and I just want to click the post button. might come back and make it less bad later

Adora wrests her aching head to the left, barely dodging another hook. She catches herself, calculatedly staggering just enough to draw her opponent in for another attack. She feints a dodge before turning the momentum against her lithe opposition, narrowly catching them in the solar plexus with her knee. She delights in the startled gasp wrenched from their gut. Adora takes a step forward, cautious yet confident.

A brutal uppercut just misses the underside of her jaw. She takes the hit with practiced composure, just now beginning to worry. Her actions grow more sluggish with each passing moment, the other fighter clearly intending to wear her down.

Adora makes a false sweep towards their leg, then hooks it to catch the back of their knee. Her leg hits only air. She faintly hears dirt kick up behind her. She sees stars, her skull erupting in virulent pain. She whips around, bringing her hands up only to catch a palm-strike to the nose. In a wild motion, she desperately throws a wild haymaker. Everything goes black.

Catra's opponent collapses in a heap with the last hit. Pure silence washes over the arena - then the crowd roars. Several jeers and insults are hurled, no doubt. She cocks a wry smirk, more than happy to play the villain for today.

Without ceremony, she retrieves her earnings and walks off, having no more desire to put on a show now that her injuries begin to take their toll. Adrenaline may well be the only thing keeping her conscious, so she bolts in the direction of her inn and hopping up the balcony and into her window. She manages to strip the boiled leather, though she doesn't bother disrobing further as she falls on her bed in a daze.

Sleep doesn't come swiftly, shockingly. Thoughts of home drift in and out, her fur bristling instinctively. Intermittently, memories best left forgotten drag her from the very edge of rest on more than one occasion.

"Faster, you worthless mongrel. Duck the overhead - why can't you even do this *right?"*

Time once, Catra would have considered sprinting away and barricading herself in her room - but her spirit had broken long ago. She pushed through the drills, she begrudgingly obeyed Weaver, and she stayed within the fenceline at all times. She was a model child by any definition... and yet, she was only admonished.

Her parents had paid *this monster to treat her like that - as though this built character, as though it would 'correct' her. Catra had always been too 'boylike', apparently, what with her passing interest in puglism and her aversion to dresses and male suitors. She realized long ago that this was a mere punishment intended to force her to change her mind, and as such vehemently refused to back down. She had endured the beatings and early waking for three long years, and she wasn't keen to retreat any time soon.*

When she finally broke free, she'd torn out on her own path.

Catra looks to her helmet on the bent stool, grimacing. She hates the damn thing, along with those ridiculous shoes and gloves they forced upon her. She's sick of being made to play human, like her ears and tail make *her* unfit for public viewing, but the brawls she takes part in are perfectly acceptable. She is a tool to them and nothing more, robbed even of the most basic respect. Each and every time she entered a damn tournament, her accolades meant *nothing*, she had to win as C'yra or not at all.

A loud scraping noise breaks her focus. Her left ear twitches slightly, easily placing it at the bottom of the stairs to the left of her room. Instinct calls her to extend her claws, standing and

bracing herself to the side of the door, prepared to get a jump should the assailant force their entry.

The steps approached - definitely human - and came to a halt in front of her door. Catra's heart pounds in her chest. Ten seconds passed, then twenty. A minute. Finally, there is motion.

A knock resounds through the room, followed by a feminine voice. "Is this C'yra? It's She-Ra, I was the, um, finalist. Alongside you."

Catra scoffs, simultaneously impressed with the gall to show up like this after a defeat and disappointed with the utter lack of confidence.

"I don't do rematches, and no, I won't split the prize money with you."

The woman behind the door chuckles. "No, nothing of the sort. I just wanted to talk. You left... an impression on me."

Curiosity compels her to swing the door ajar. The woman is blonde, nearly six feet tall, and decked to the nines in muscle barely obscured by her longsleeve white tunic. She barely manages to stop her eyes from crawling over every inch of her, making eye contact at last.

And they wonder why I was never fond of courting men.

Catra smirks stiffly, her eyes searching for hints of proposition. "And what kind of impression might that be?"

Adora's face burns a bright pink and she stammers, "N-No! Not, uh, not like that. You're..." she looks Catra up and down glacially, continuing, "*incredibly* fetching, but- why did I say that? Shit, um... I just wanted to learn more. From you. About how you fight." By the end of her explanation, she's evolved beyond pink to the utmost crimson and it's begun reaching her ears.

"Rrrrrright." Catra knowingly drawls the word, internally cackling at the embarrassment it draws out. "And you're here well after

sunset to 'learn how to fight'?" she exaggerates.

Adora stares back with a gormless expression, offering a half-hearted "Yes?"

With a sigh, Catra steps to the side and waves her in. "Hurry up, before someone gets pissy."

The blonde scrambles inside with a mix of fear and elatement on her face, standing in the corner of the small room. Catra sits with her legs hanging over the edge of the bed, thinking about what the hell she should do next.

"So, uh... who taught you? I had a tutor, but she clearly had nothing on you-"

Catra growls in warning. "She's dead to me. I fight by myself, for myself." She adjusts the hem of her nightshirt, not commenting on the way Adora's eyes follow her hand.

Adora bites her lip. "I meant no disrespect." After a few moments of awkward silence, she coughs, then continues, "My friend, Glimmer, thought you were cheating, and I-"

Her sentence is interrupted as Catra snarls, standing and lurching forward to box her against the wall, claws digging into the burdened wood at either side of her head. "Oh yeah? And what did you tell her, exactly?"

Catra watches as Adora's adam's apple travels up and down along her throat. Pointedly, she returns her stare to Adora's cerulean eyes, tension palpable as the blonde sweats bullets.

"I, um, I told her that you fought fair. I said- I tried to say that you were just better - than me, I mean - and, uh, she said it was bullshit. She might, uh..." Adora trails off, her gaze flicking down to Catra's lips and back up.

Catra draws in closer. Adora's wide eyes and wandering gaze finally break her resolve. She slowly leans in, never breaking eye

contact.

Adora meets her halfway. The world goes still as their lips collide. Catra quickly cedes ground to Adora, her passion overwhelming. Within moments, their positions have inverted, silence broken only by gasping breaths taken in blessedly brief intermissions.

Catra shields her eyes from the blinding light of dawn, catching a glance of her rousing bedmate. She brings a hand up to caress her cheek, whispering softly,

"Still wanna learn more, princess?"

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